



Global Honorarium Policy

Scope

This policy is applicable for Associates who contribute towards:

- Global Skilling Programs
- Campus Graduate Programs – GGM & Americas
- GenC Skilling Program – India

This policy does not apply to:

- Third party sub-contractors.
- Associates from the Delivery Excellence team who handle training sessions on Process and Quality related topics.
- Associates from corporate functions.
- Associates in Associate Deployment Pool (ADP) - If the trainer contributes towards delivering training sessions while in Associate Deployment Pool (ADP), they are not eligible for Honorarium. However, if the trainer contributes towards delivering training sessions while being part of a project and thereafter moved to ADP, is eligible for Honorarium.
- For sessions recorded as 'Self-reported training' on Cognizant LEARN, i.e., Knowledge Transfer, Project discussion sessions.
- For Internal sessions conducted within the project (Session flagged with "- R "in the activity / class code).
- BU Associates whose job description is a full-time trainer catering to all the training requirements for the BU, even if their BU allocation is active.
- Associates allocated to GenC or L&D projects for training purpose.

Guiding principles

Honorarium is a voluntary payment given to an Associates for services which do not require fees to be paid legally or traditionally.

This document defines Cognizant Learning and Development's (L&D's) Honorarium Payout Policy and process for Associates who contribute to learning through:

- Conducting training programs (must be part of Cognizant Learning and Development (L&D) Catalog with a course code)
- Learning Content creation

Translations

[French \(Canada\)](#)

Key Definitions

Honorarium: Method of recognizing the associates who contributed towards learning either by conducting sessions or by learning asset (courseware / assessment) development.

Generation Cognizant (GenC): Graduate or Under-graduate students hired in India as full-time employees for Program Trainee (PT), Program Analyst Trainee (PAT), Analyst Trainee (AT) levels from educational institutions, including those with a master's degree, with or without prior work experience. GenC in location other than India are referred to as Campus graduate hires.

Evaluation (Cognizant LEARN / Tecstac terminology): referred to as Participant's feedback.

Related Policies & Processes

- [Honorarium Calculation Methodology](#)
- [Honorarium Calculation Methodology – GenC India Skilling](#)

Contribution towards training

Honorarium will be paid to Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) from Business Units who deliver training programs organized by the Cognizant Learning and Development team (L&D). This is subject to the instructor completing all their deliverables viz., delivering training on the scheduled dates (mutually accepted between L&D and Subject Matter Experts (SME), ensuring the required evaluation response rate, maintaining the timelines, and marking attendance.

Honorarium payout will be paid in local currency and will be credited along with the monthly salary and the payout is processed as below:

- Sessions with feedback closure dates in the previous month would be considered for payout in the current month (E.g.: The sessions with feedback survey end date between 1st December '20 to 31st December '20 – Honorarium will be paid with the January 2021 salary). However, it might vary with the payroll processing dates for the specific country.
- Honorarium payout is based on the process defined in the Honorarium Calculation Methodology document.
- If more than one (1) trainer handles the session and if it is not accurately captured in the session pattern, the training hours will be equally split among the trainers and Honorarium will be processed accordingly.
- If feedback (evaluation in Cognizant LEARN for Global L&D Skilling Program & Campus graduate program; evaluation on Tekstac for GenC Skilling - India) is not collected for a session, the feedback (evaluation) will be considered as "Good" and processed with the approval of the respective Learning Delivery Head. This will be considered only if the session was scheduled in the last three (3) months.

Contribution towards learning content

Honorarium is applicable only for:

- Cognizant Learning and Development (L&D) owned topics that are listed in the learning catalog (Cognizant LEARN) and GenC curriculum maintained by the Solutions Team.
- Courses / assessments that have undergone "Revamp".

Associate's details to be shared by the respective solution owner from Cognizant Learning and Development (L&D) on or before 30th of every month to initiate the processing for the following month's payout.

Exception management

Any exceptions to the honorarium calculation will require the approval of the respective Learning Delivery Head (Global Skilling Program / Gen C India Skilling) as applicable.

Policy modifications

Cognizant reserves the right to amend its policies as necessary. Any changes to the L&D - Global Honorarium Policy will be approved by the Global Head of Learning & Development.

Version history

Revision Date	Description of Change
JUL-01-2021	Initial release
JUN-14-2023	Standardization of Template
MAY-09-2025	Included GenC in scope Updated Exception Management on approval from the Learning Delivery Heads.

Policy control information

Policy Name: Global Honorarium Policy

Department: Learning and Development

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Effective Date: JUL-01-2021

Policy Owner: Head of Learning & Development